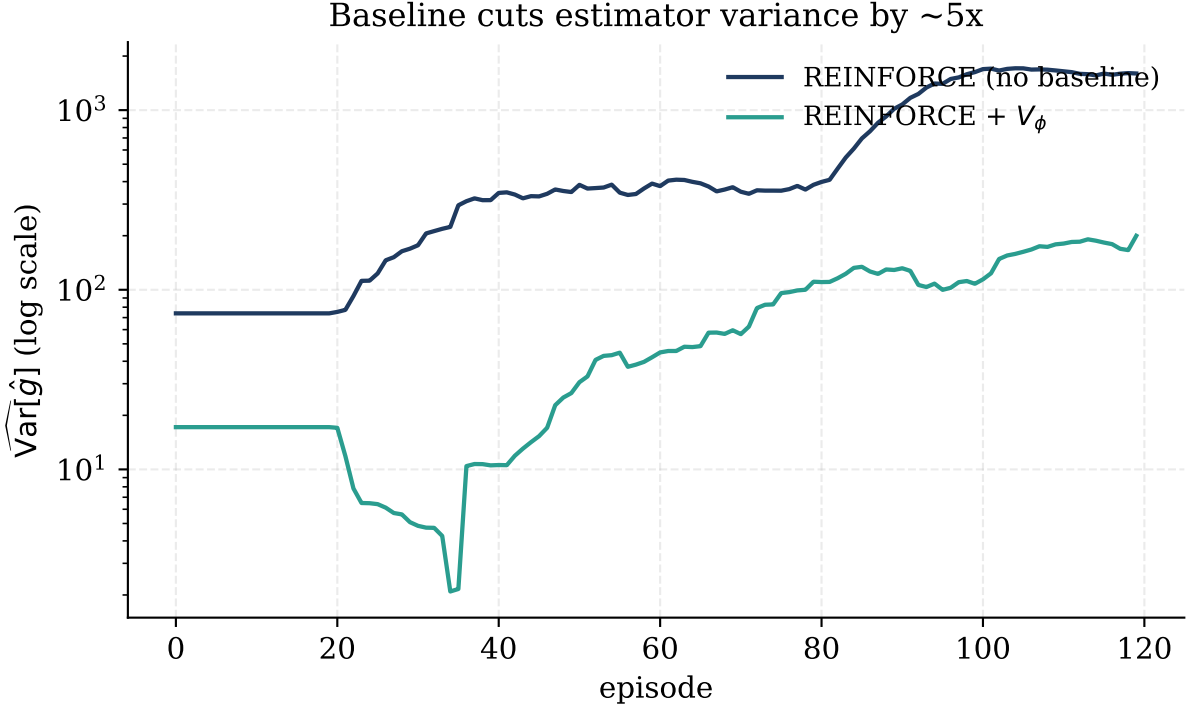
Baseline cuts estimator variance by ~5x
REINFORCE (no baseline)
REINFORCE + V_ϕ
$\widehat{\mathrm{Var}}[\hat{g}]$ (log scale)
10^3
10^2
10^1
0
20
40
60
80
100
120
episode